



Referral Network for Independent Professionals

Referna matches independent professionals (fractional execs, AI consultants, GEO specialists, and more) into referral circles where trusted peers refer clients to each other.

Pre-Seed Round

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

BASICS

Problem	Independent professionals' #1 problem is getting the next client.	CUSTOMER →
Solution	Referna matches them into circles of trusted peers who refer clients to each other.	SOLUTION →

EVIDENCE

Will they refer each other?	340K members of an offline network (BNI) pay \$800/yr to refer \$26.4B/yr — for 40 years.	INCUMBENT →
Can we get users?	30% reply rate to cold email. 80% positive. 20× industry average.	MARKET PULL →

SIZE

Are there many customers?	130M independent professionals globally; 9.26M addressable in the US.	MARKET →
Will it have a moat?	Networks have great moats — and grow fast once seeded.	OPPORTUNITY →

TIMING

Why now	AI is approaching the inflection point where it can facilitate the circles BNI needs 40,000 operators to run.	WHY NOW →
Why us?	We love networks — built 3 already. 2 exits. 2nd startup together.	TEAM →

CUSTOMER

Meet Ami, an independent professional

**Ami B.**

Agentic Marketing Consultant · sells to early-stage · self employed

HERZLIYA · REAL · REACHABLE FOR REFERENCE

\$150K

2025 REVENUE

HIS #1 PROBLEM

Getting the next client.

"That's my #1 problem — isn't it everyone's top one?"

Ami B. · April 2026

***24 of 26** independent professionals interviewed
agreed with Ami.*

Referna interviews · April 2026

→ For independent professionals like Ami - **getting the next client is the top problem.**

Source: Ami B. interview (Apr 2026)

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Ami joins a circle of trusted peers who refer clients to each other.



Each referral builds more trust in the circle — that's the flywheel.

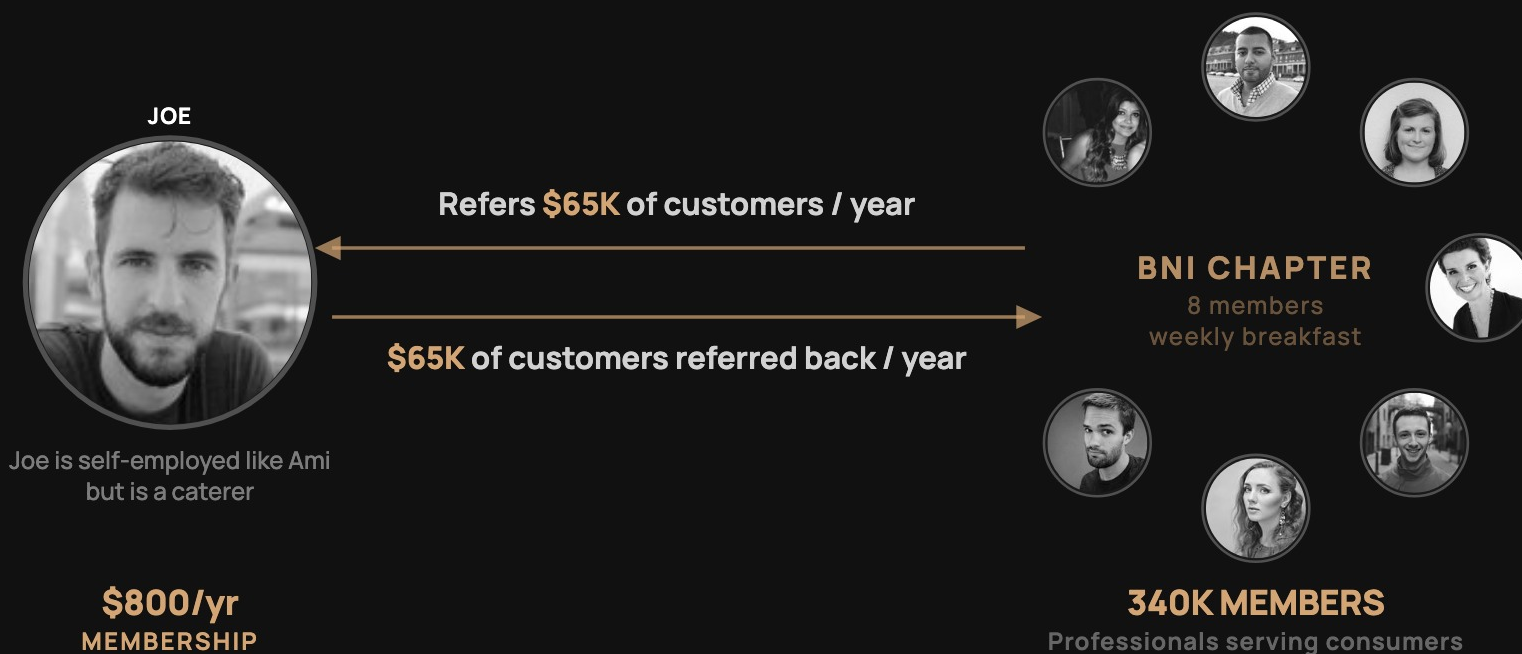
→ For Ami — **circles solve the next-client problem.** He just needs to find his circle.

Sources: Referna interviews · BNI Mid-Year Report 2025

INCUMBENT

BNI: Referral network — \$26.4B referrals/year

Referna and BNI have the same concept — trusted peers refer clients



→ BNI proved **the model and market** but its legacy methods are limiting growth

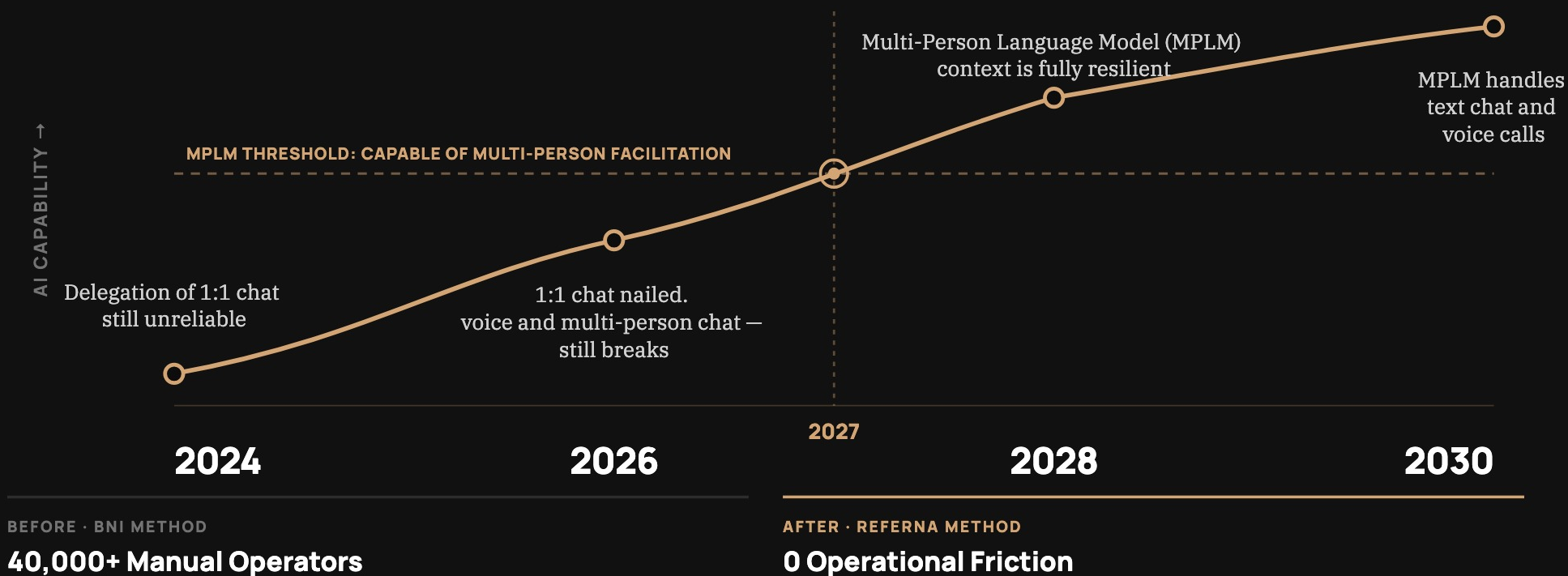
Sources: BNI Mid-Year Report 2025; bni.com; BNI US membership fees (\$575–\$849/yr, 1-year participation)

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WHY NOW

MPLMs Defeat the Franchise Model

Replacing a legacy army of 40,000+ manual operators (BNI method) with the infinite software scale of **Multi-Person Language Models (MPLMs)**.



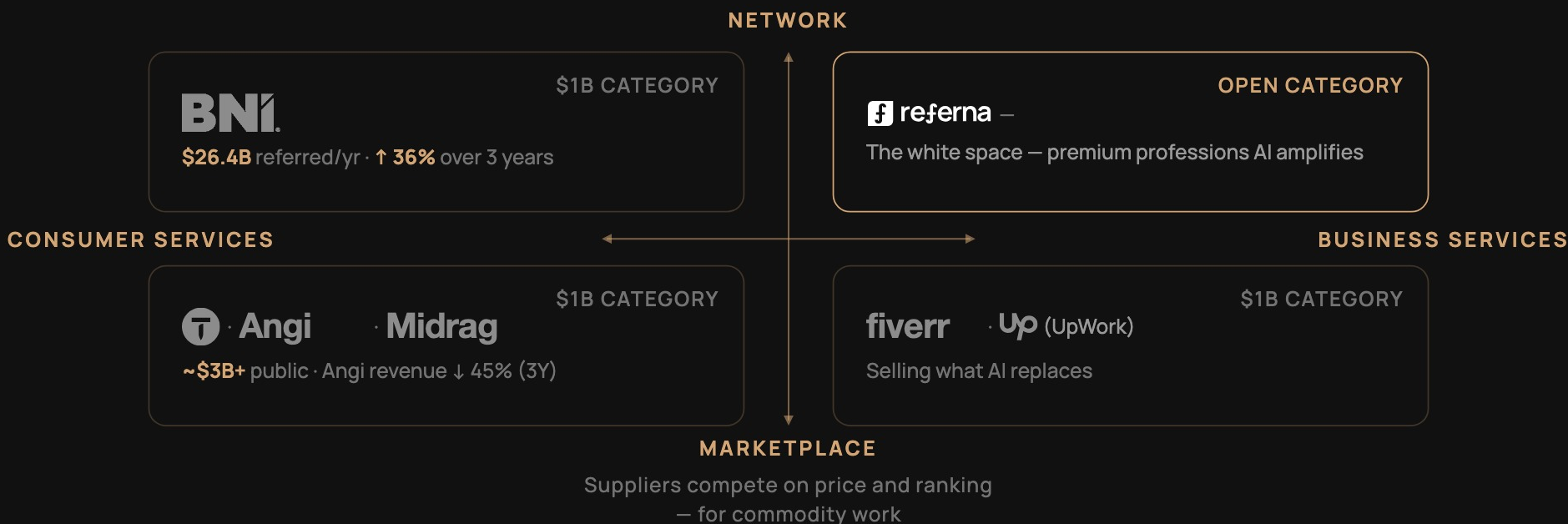
→ **MPLMs shift a legacy franchise model into a high-margin, venture-scale network.**

Sources: Referna analysis · multi-person context-window trajectory · BNI operational structure

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CATEGORY

What Referna is — and isn't



YPO = peer development for CEOs — different audience, not a referral network.

LinkedIn = different beast — professional graph monetized by ads and recruiters, not a lead source for independent professionals.

→ Each category is a billion-dollar business. The missing quadrant is ours.

Sources: BNI Mid-Year Report 2025 · public filings (Fiverr, Upwork, Angi) · Thumbtack last private round

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The undeniable evidence

We needed proof the pain was urgent.

So we sent 139 cold emails to strangers.

→ A 20× signal is hard to ignore — and shows we can grow fast.

Sources: Referna outbound · 5 referral-offer campaigns · May 2026

DISTRIBUTION

The 30.2% wasn't the only test.

We ran weekly tests — focused on cracking distribution before building product.

N=134

Weekly growth

50%+

W/W USER GROWTH

77

WAU LAST WEEK

7× YC's "good" threshold (5–7%).
134 registered in first 6 weeks.

N=139 VS 5,201 CONTROL

Cold email → onboarded

6.7%

OF EMAILS REACH ONBOARDED

Cold outreach converts.

N=14

Virality

3.5

INVITES / USER

29%

ACCEPTANCE

Each user brings in one more. Rare.

WHAT WE DISPROVED

Enterprise salespeople want referrals → DISPROVED

Independent professionals want random intros → DISPROVED

Facebook groups would drive signups → DISPROVED (NO GEOGRAPHIC DENSITY)

→ We believe data, not opinions. **The data says Go.**

Sources: Referna growth dashboard (n=134, Jul 13, 2026) · YC growth thresholds (Paul Graham)

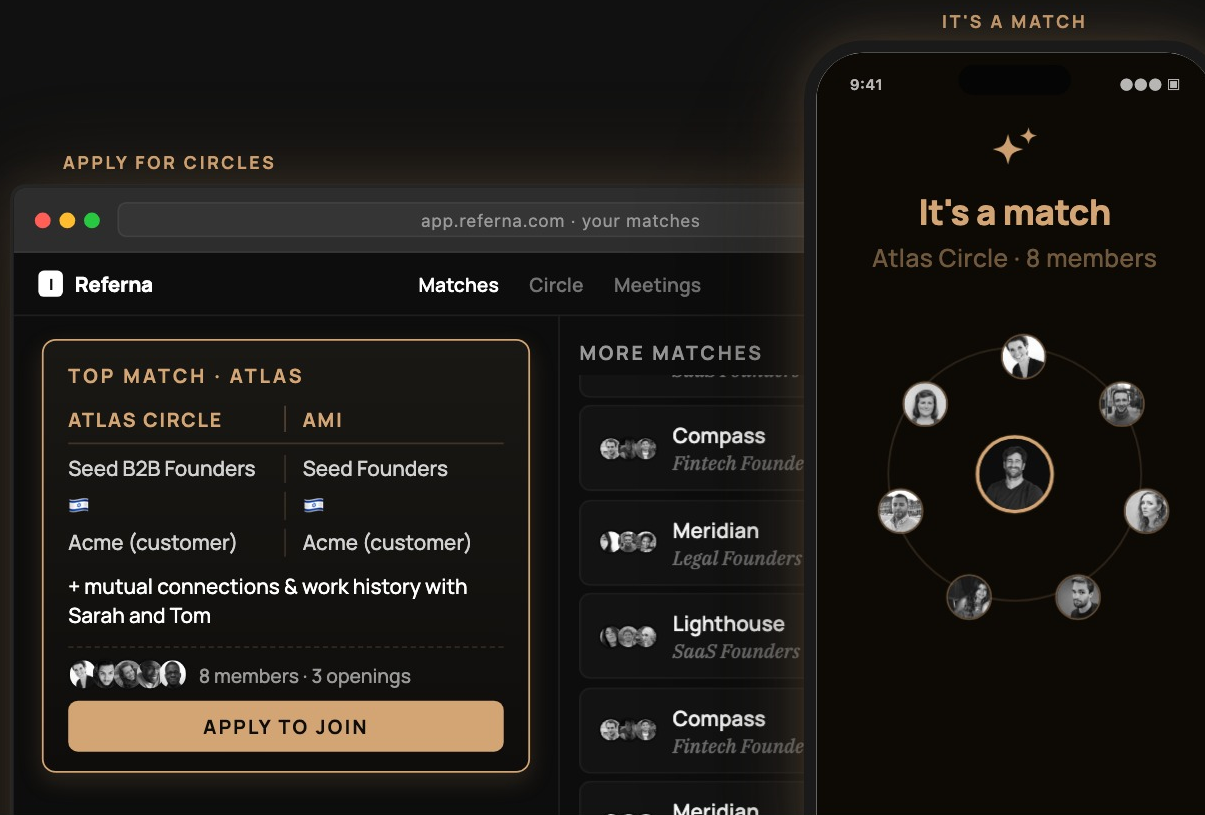
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PRODUCT 1

Referna matches like online dating

Ami finds his circle

- *Matched by who they serve, not where they live*
- *Selected by ability to create trust with the circle — equal standing, mutual connections, common interests*
- *Ami has a circle of 8-12 helping each other*



- **Referna lets independent professionals find each other and unlocks circle creation.**

Sources: Match.com (1995), eHarmony (2000), Referna product · n=134

PRODUCT 2

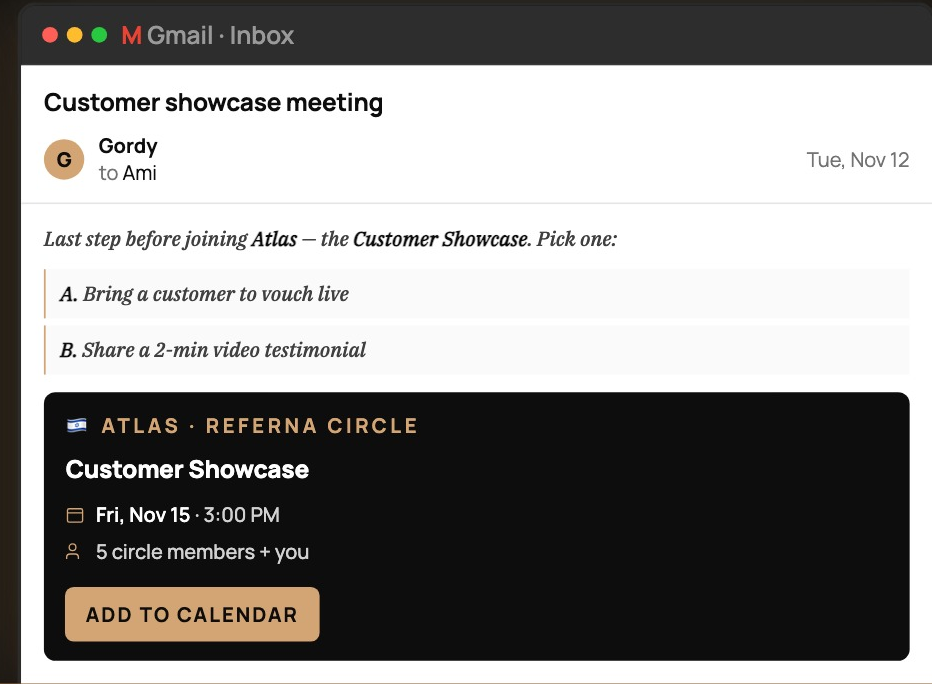
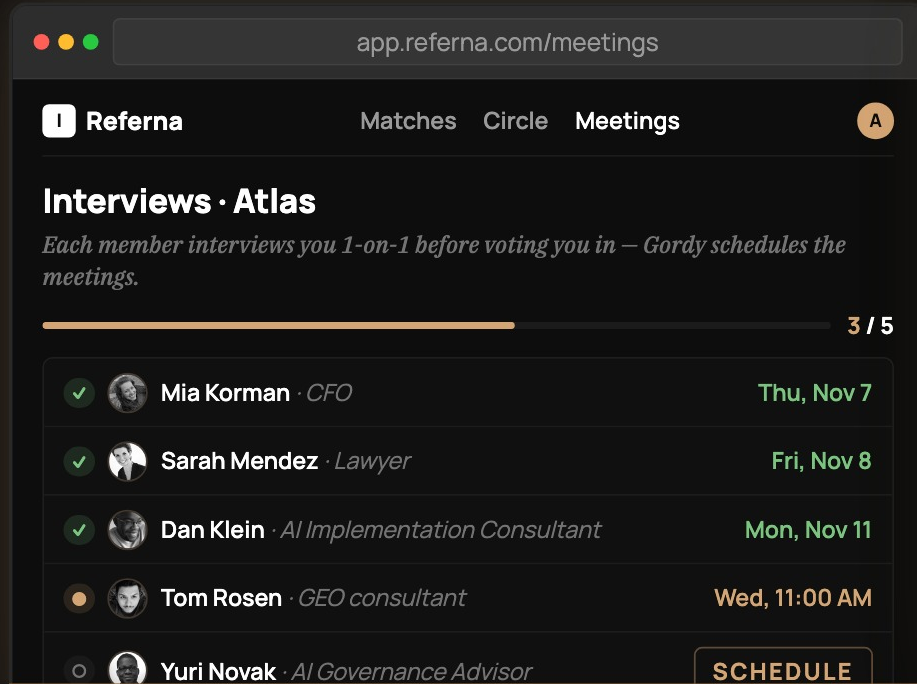
Referna solves trust like corporate onboarding

Ami meets every member before being accepted

Each member builds rapport and starts trusting him

Ami shows a success story

Members learn to trust Ami's ability to deliver value



→ Referna builds trust early — the first referral kickstarts the flywheel.

Sources: Referna product; trust formation research (Granovetter, Cialdini)

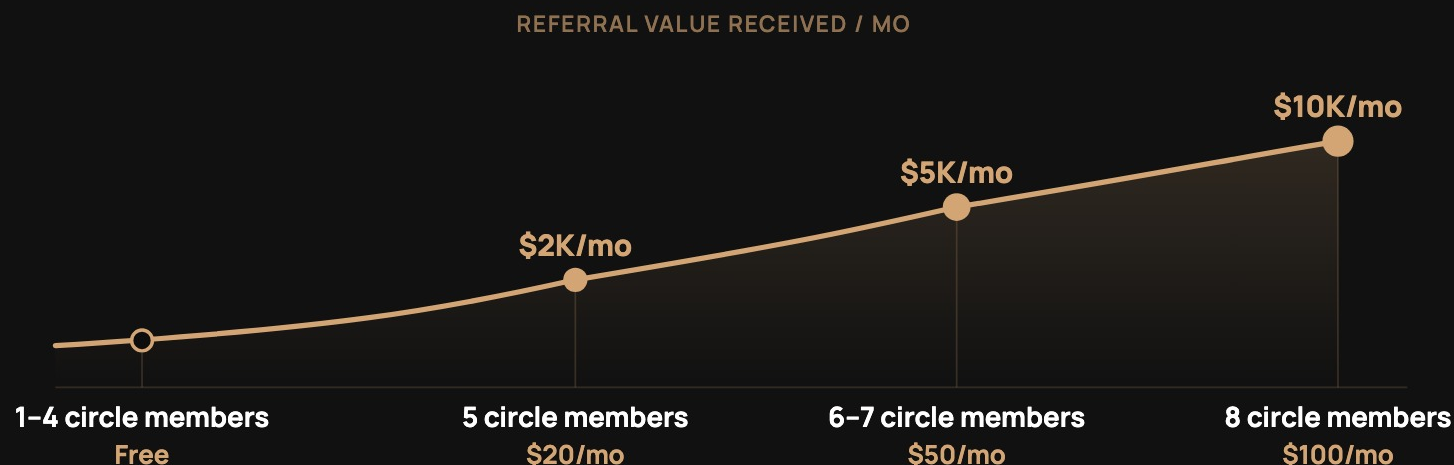
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BIZ MODEL

Referna makes money by charging a membership fee.

LOW FRICTION

Starts free

CAPTURES 1%
of value created

→ Proven business model that captures 1% of generated value with low friction.

Sources: Referna pricing schedule · monthly figures per member, illustrative (fee = 1% of referral value) · BNI, YPO, TAB also charge membership fees

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MARKET

21 segments. Startups segment first.

~130M independent professionals worldwide

2.20M in the US, across 5 segments

\$926B REFERRAL MARKET VOLUME
(math: ~\$100K per professional)



→ **9.26M** addressable but **starting where we'll grow fastest.**

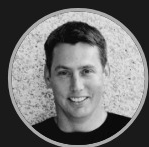
Sources: US Census Bureau, BLS, LinkedIn (1.3B members, 2026), Referna market analysis

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TEAM

Two founders, two exits

3.5 years working together



Yaniv Nizan

Co-Founder & CEO

- CEO & co-founder of SOOMLA (acquired by ironSource/Unity)
- Built 3 networks — IntentClick (\$4M ARR ad network at Kontera), SOOMLA's payer-data network, SOOMLA's ad-creative network
- Customer in 4 referral-driven segments — startups, divorce, home-building, weddings



Matan Protter

Co-Founder & CTO

- CTO & co-founder of Infinity (acquired by Alibaba)
- 9 patents
- Talpiot graduate · PhD Technion
- 3.5 years shipping products with Yaniv — SynqUp and Referna



→ **Second startup together. 30+ combined years of building products.**

Sources: founder track records

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ROUND

Pre-seed for 24 months

12-month milestone: 4,000 Weekly Active Users

IT'S ACHIEVABLE

4.4K WAU = 131K addresses × 6.7% (email → onboarded) × 50% (onboarded → weekly active).

IT'S ENOUGH FOR SEED

- Network businesses raise seed at this scale (Clubhouse, Boardy, ...).
- 4,000 WAU → ~500 weekly referrals → ~\$130M annualized economic value.

WHAT WE NEED

Pre-seed · 24 months runway · Team of 4 (founders + 2 Talpiot graduates) · 12m buffer before seed.

Active = engaged with another user in the last 7 days

Referral = introduction at the moment of need (proof: the call)

→ 4,000 active is **seed-ready scale** for a network business — and we have the path.

Sources: Referna product data; segment sizing (slide 8)

Why this is a great opportunity

Proven model.

BNI runs the offline version at
\$26.4B/yr — 340K members.

Fast growth.

50%+ W/W growth.
77 WAU, 134 registered in 6 weeks.
6.7% cold-email to onboarded.
30.2% smoke-test reply rate.

Winning team.

Two post-exit founders.
Second startup together.
3.5 years of cohesion.

We're moving fast. Move with us.